

Japan Expansion: Glocalizing Freedom & Responsibility

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Overview



Netflix has an opportunity to capitalize on Japan's high-value streaming market, but its current model risks limiting access to premium IP due to cultural misalignment

Problem

- Cultural misalignment in Japan
- Develop trust with studios
- Risk to premium content access

Solution

- Structured autonomy
- Long-term partnerships
- Local talent development

Approach

- Market + cultural analysis
- Case-based insights
- Studio ecosystem evaluation

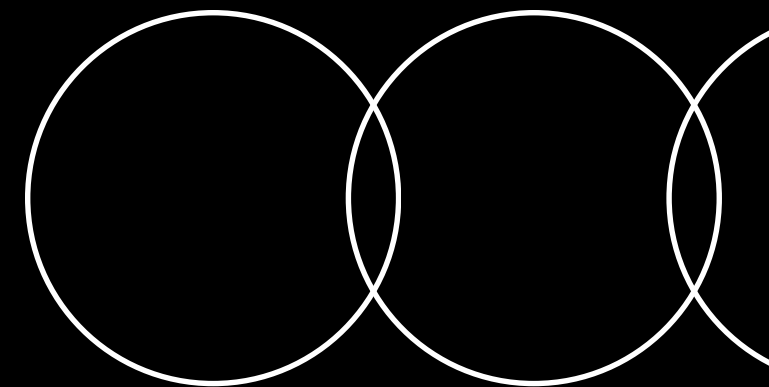
Impact

- Stronger studio trust
- Access to premium IP
- Scalable global content

Problem Statement

Challenges in Workforce Integration

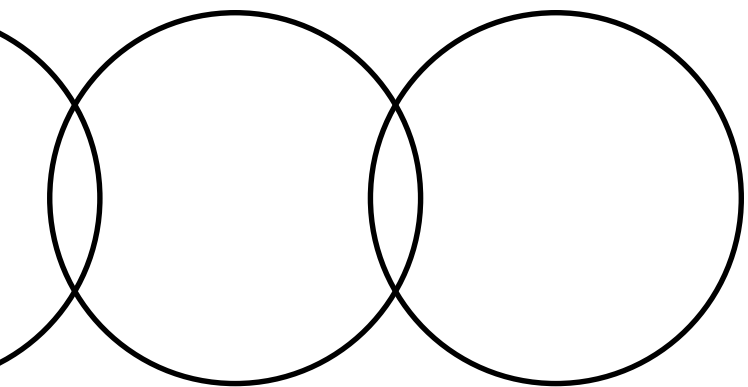
Netflix's expansion into Japan requires balancing its core value of operational flexibility with Japan's relationship-driven, risk-averse studio culture, where failure to establish trust and structured partnerships could limit access to high-quality anime production and reduce long-term market success.



Lessons from Market Entries

Walmart and Google Insights

Walmart's failure to adapt its management style led to a disconnect with Japanese consumers, while Google succeeded by embracing localized leadership and structured approaches.

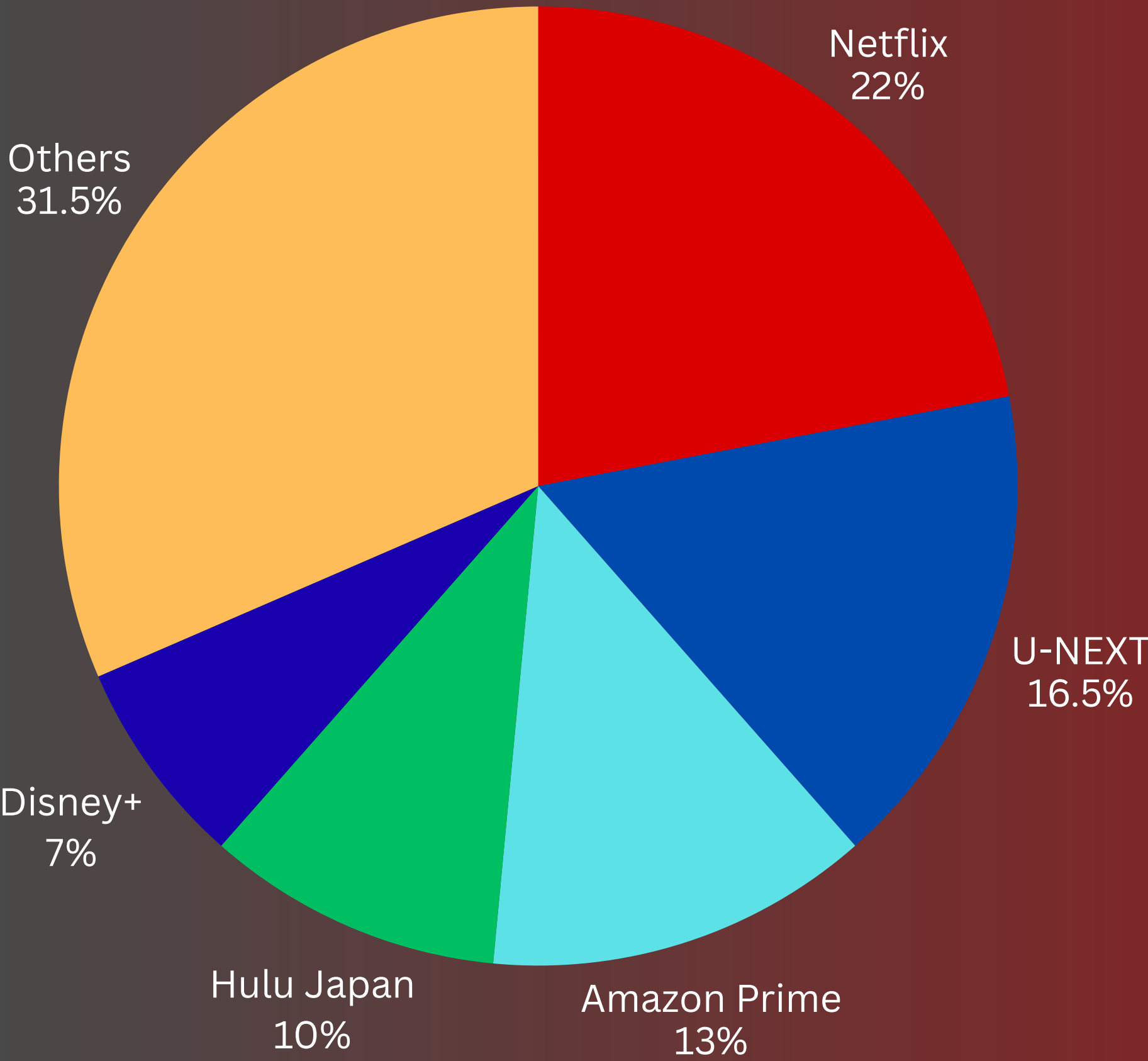


Walmart

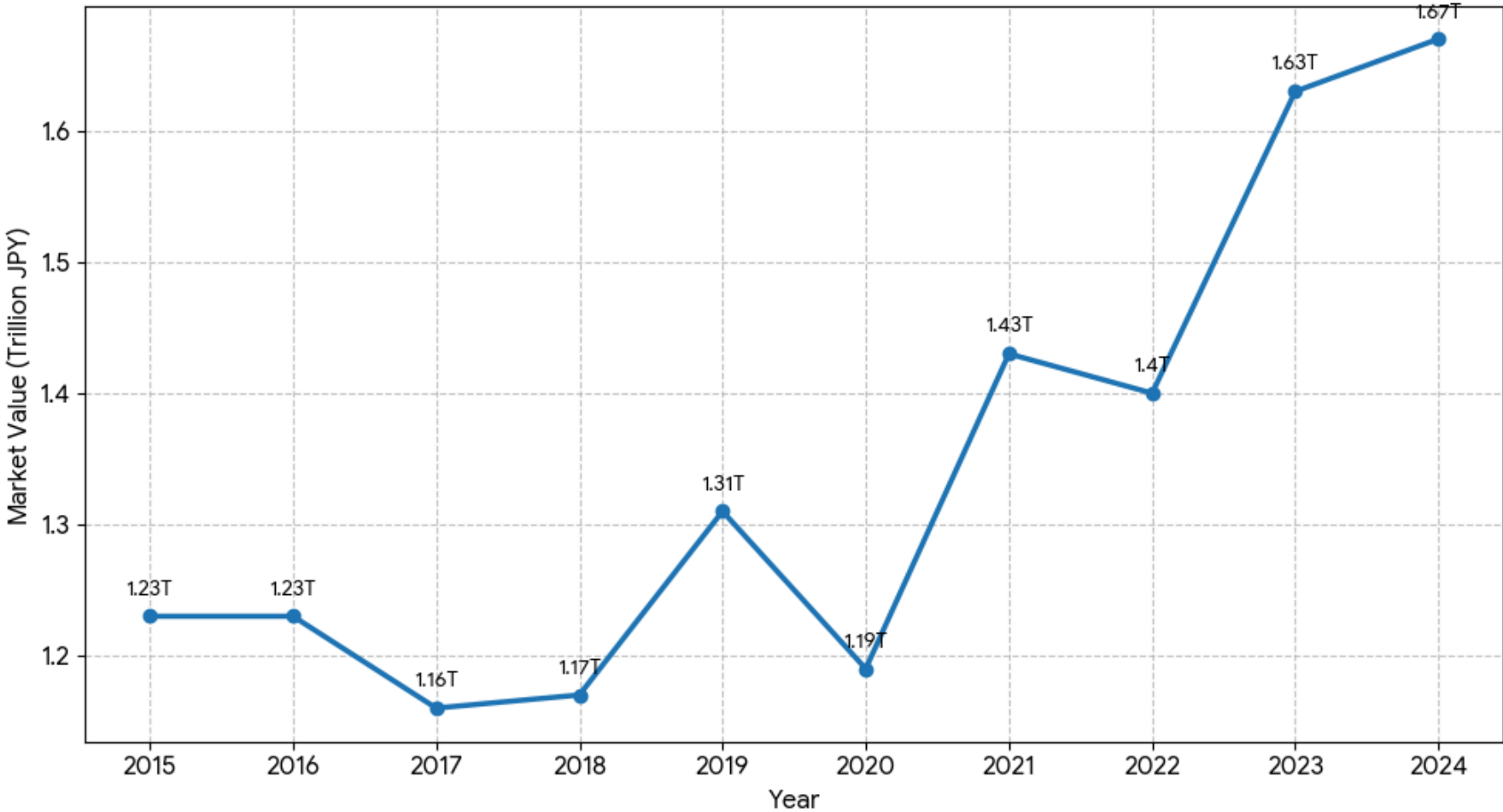
Google



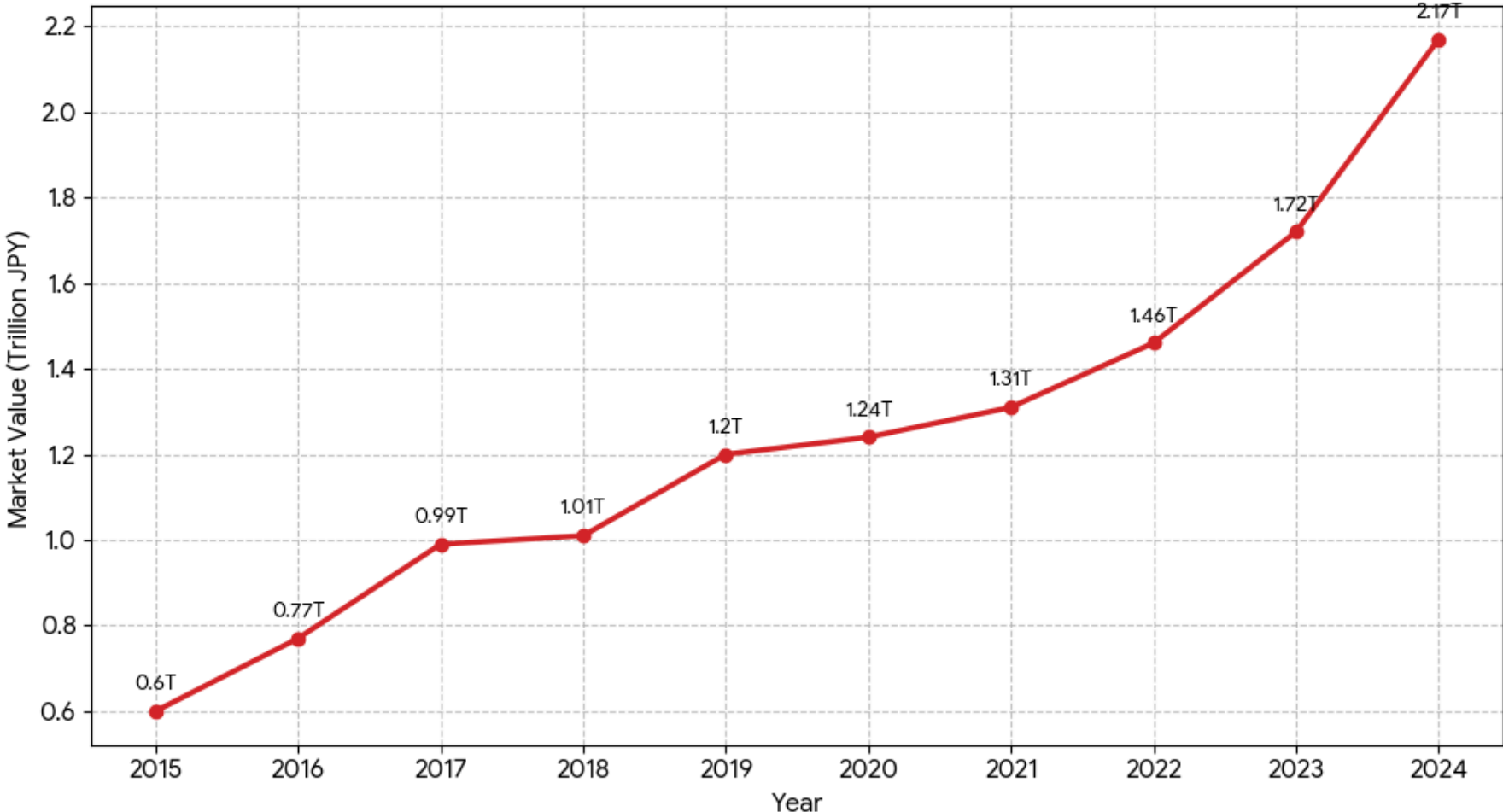
Japan Streaming Market Share (Revenue-Based)



Growth of Anime Market within Japan (Domestic)



Growth of Anime in the International Market (Overseas)



Long-Term Partnership as Competitive Advantage

Why Tokyo requires a different expansion strategy



Studio Ecosystem

Reputation-driven, relationship-oriented, hierarchical, and IP-focused — decisions reflect long horizons and risk aversion.



Netflix Culture Contrast

Fast decision-making, high autonomy, and cancellation-led performance models can signal instability to Japanese partners.



Strategic Question

How does Netflix adapt to win trust in Tokyo without diluting core values?

Unfreeze – Preparing for Change

Months 1–3

Goal

Break the status quo and make people recognize the need for the collaboration.

Key Actions

- Create urgency using market data and competitor information
- Highlight financial gain potential or loss of opportunity
- Reemphasize Netflix's Cultural Deck values innovation
- Acknowledge risks with cross-cultural collaborative change



Change - Implementing New Processes

Months 4-9

Goal

Move towards the new desired state through education, training, and support during transition.

Key Actions

- Establish leadership development for bicultural leaders
- Hiring experts who can implement learning and development initiatives
- Communicate vision to every level of organization



Refreeze – Solidifying the Change

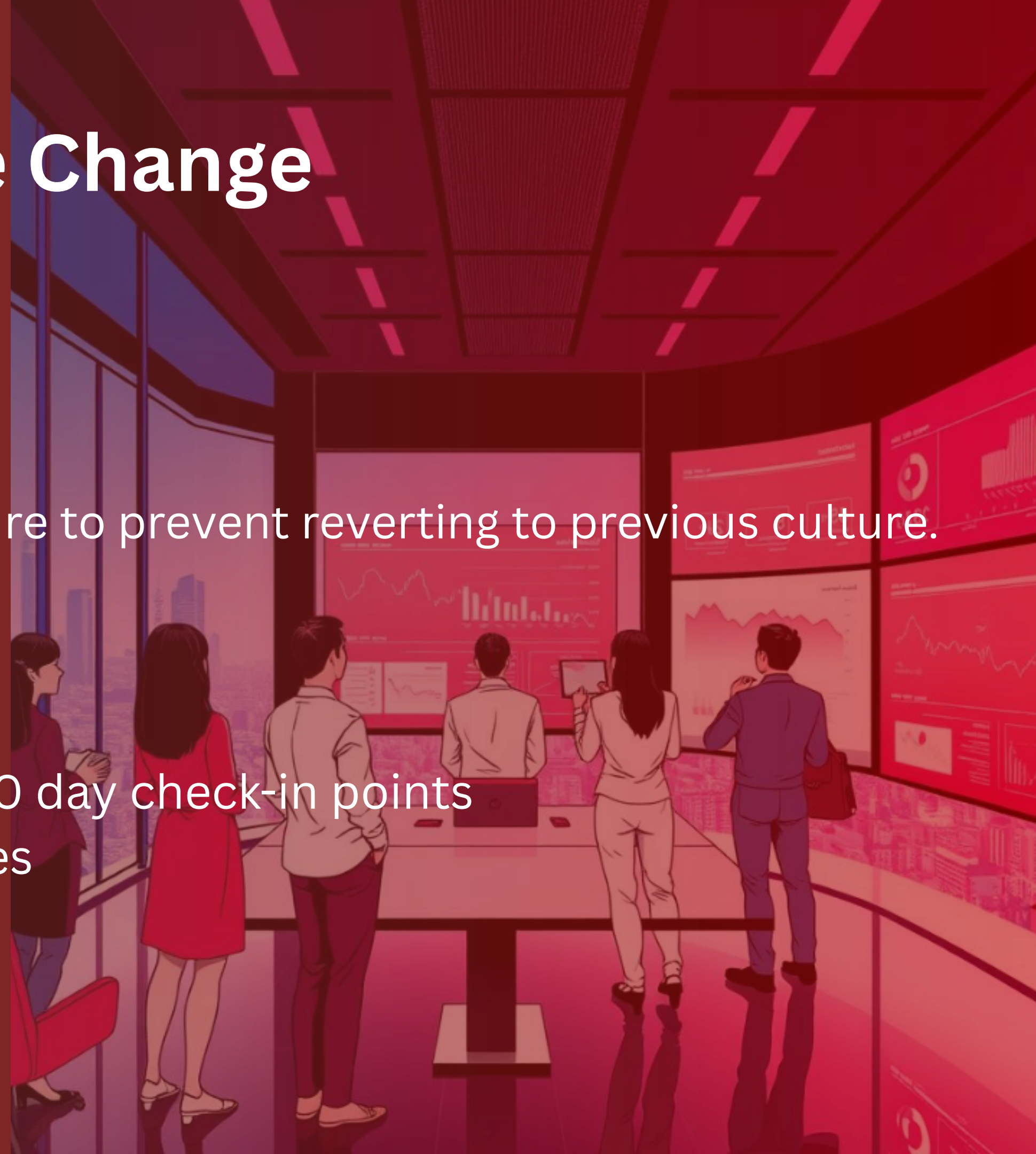
Months 10-12

Goal

Embed new changes into the company culture to prevent reverting to previous culture.

Key Actions

- Design training programs with 30-60-90 day check-in points
- Identify and mitigate potential obstacles



Netflix Japan - Operations & Culture Team

Japan Country Lead

1 person VP - level

JOB FUNCTIONS:

- Set strategic directions
- Own studio relationships
- Public face in Japan media
- Report to global leadership

Duration - Permanent(3-5 yr)

Hire : External - senior Japanese exec

Cultural Bridge Teams

3-4 people Bicultural

JOB FUNCTIONS:

- Translate intent between cultures
- Run consensus consultations
- Code Switch Communications
- Advise on partner proiocols

Duration: Permanent (12 months+)

HIRE:External - kikokushijo / expats

Partnership Managers

2-3 per studio Embedded

JOB FUNCTIONS:

- Daily studio contact
- Attend all partner meetings
- Track creative milestones
- Manage IP governance

Duration: Permanent (studio - assigned)

HIRE: Mix - 1 internal +1-2 external

Training & OD Team

2-3 people L&D experts

JOB FUNCTIONS:

- Design feedback training
- Run onboarding programs
- Build psych safety frameworks
- 30 60 90 day check ins

DURATION: 12 months (contract renewable)

HIRE:External - Japan L&D consultants

Data & Analytics

1-2 people Analysis

JOB FUNCTIONS:

- Track all KPI's
- Stage-gate investment reports
- Audience engagement analysis
- Share data with partners

Duration:Permantent (ongoing role)

HIRE:Internal - redeploy Netflix data

Netflix Japan — Financial Team Structure



NETFLIX JAPAN EXPANSION

18–24 Month Implementation Timeline

PARTNERSHIP
ECOSYSTEM



FLEXIBILITY

TRUST

CULTURAL INTEGRATION

RISK CONTROL

Risk Management: Japan Talent Strategy

Identifying, funding, and scaling local Japanese creative talent introduces high-probability risks requiring strategic mitigation.

Cultural Risks

Work culture emphasizing hierarchy and consensus may limit bold storytelling

Talent Development

Emerging creators may lack exposure to global storytelling structures

Financial Investment

Local productions without proven scalability can lead to low ROI



KPIs: What Success Looks Like

Success is defined by Netflix's ability to discover, develop, and scale Japanese talent into globally successful content creators.

Talent Development

20-30

**Local Creators
Funded**

Target in Year 1

Content Performance

70%

**Content Completion
Rate**

Global viewership

Financial Performance

1-2

Top 10 Rankings
Japanese originals
globally

ありがとう

Thank You